

User Stories, Acceptance Criteria & MoSCoW Prioritisation |

Personal Product Management Project

1. Prioritisation Approach

All user stories are tagged using the MoSCoW framework. Priority is assigned relative to the Minimum Viable Product (MVP) ,the smallest functional version of the product that delivers end-to-end value to a user and is viable for stakeholder demonstration.

M - Must Have: MVP is non-functional without it.

S - Should Have: Strong value; ships in the first post-MVP iteration.

C - Could Have: Adds polish; goes into the backlog.

W - Won't Have (V1): Explicitly deferred to V2+.

2. Prototype Scope Note

Of the 22 stories below, 9 map directly to screens visible in the pitch prototype. The remaining 13 describe backend logic recommendation scoring, bureau fetch, feature generation, persona classification that is real product behaviour but invisible to a stakeholder watching a demo. Both sets are documented here for completeness and developer handoff. The prototype focuses on the following 9 stories: US-01, US-02, US-03, US-04, US-17, US-15, US-16, US-18, and US-22.

3. User Stories by Epic

Epic 1 Onboarding & Consent

US-01 Mobile Verification [Must Have]	
User Story	As a new user, I want to verify my mobile number via OTP, so that my identity is confirmed before any financial data is accessed.
Acceptance Criteria	
– OTP is delivered within 3 seconds of submission.	
– OTP expires after 5 minutes.	

– User get up to 3 resend attempts before a 10-minute cooldown is applied.
– Invalid OTP shows an inline error without clearing the number field.
– On success, the user proceeds to PAN entry without re-entering their number.

US-02 PAN Verification [Must Have]	
User Story	As a user, I want to verify my PAN, so that my identity is matched to bureau records and my application can be pre-filled.
Acceptance Criteria	
– PAN format is validated client-side before submission (format: AAAAAA9999A).	
– PAN is verified against NSDL/UIDAI in under 4 seconds.	
– If PAN already exists in the system, user is routed to a returning user flow.	
– Failed verification shows a clear error with a retry option.	
– PAN is masked in all subsequent UI screens after verification.	

US-03 SMS Read Consent [Must Have]	
User Story	As a user, I want to clearly understand what SMS data will be read before I give consent, so that I trust the platform with my information.
Acceptance Criteria	
– Consent screen explicitly lists the 5 categories being read: salary, EMI, utilities, shopping, travel.	
– Plain language used no legal jargon on the primary consent screen.	
– Full legal text available via an expandable 'Read More' link.	
– Both Accept and Skip options are equally visible.	
– If skipped, the system routes to the explicit preference flow without blocking progression.	
– Consent timestamp and choice are logged for compliance.	

US-04 Bureau Soft Pull Consent [Must Have]	
User Story	As a user, I want to be told that checking my credit score will not affect it, so that I feel safe consenting to a bureau pull.
Acceptance Criteria	

– Screen explicitly states: 'This is a soft pull no impact on your CIBIL score.'
– Explanation of what bureau data will be used for is shown in 2 sentences or fewer.
– Accept and Skip options are both clearly visible.
– If skipped, recommendation is generated without approval probability indicators.
– Consent logged with timestamp.

US-05 Bank Statement Upload [Could Have]	
User Story	As a user with limited SMS history, I want to upload my bank statement, so that I can still get a personalized recommendation.
Acceptance Criteria	
– Accepts PDF format, maximum 10 MB.	
– Supports statements from the top 10 Indian banks.	
– Upload is optional and clearly labelled as such.	
– Parsing completes within 15 seconds; the user sees a progress indicator.	
– If parsing fails, the user is informed and routed to the explicit preference flow.	

Epic 2 Financial Analysis

US-06 On-Device SMS Parsing [Must Have]	
User Story	As a user, I want my SMS messages to be read on my device without being sent to any server, so that my private financial messages stay private.
Acceptance Criteria	
– SMS parsing runs entirely within the app; no raw message content leaves the device.	
– Only structured signals are transmitted (e.g., salary amount, merchant category, date).	
– Parsing covers at least 6 months of messages or up to 500 messages, whichever is greater.	
– Completes in under 5 seconds on a mid-range Android device.	
– If fewer than 3 months of parseable data are found, system flags the session for preference supplement.	

- Works offline does not require an active internet connection during parsing.

US-07 Bureau Data Fetch [Must Have]

User Story	As a user, I want my credit profile to be fetched automatically after I give consent, so that my recommendation reflects my actual credit health.
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Acceptance Criteria

- Bureau API call is made within 2 seconds of consent acceptance.
- Response received and processed within 5 seconds.
- On API timeout (over 5 seconds), the system retries once, then proceeds without bureau data.
- Bureau failure does not block the recommendation, it suppresses approval probability only.
- Credit score, utilisation ratio, and active credit lines are stored as session data only.
- User is never shown raw bureau data in the recommendation flow.

US-08 Behavioural Feature Generation [Must Have]

User Story	As the recommendation engine, I need structured behavioural scores from raw financial signals, so that I can rank cards against the user's actual spending profile.
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Acceptance Criteria

- System generates all 8 behavioural scores: Travel Affinity, Cashback Affinity, Fuel Dependency, Dining & Lifestyle, Online Shopping Intensity, Credit Health, Salary Stability, and EMI Burden Ratio.
- Each score is on a 0–100 scale, except EMI Burden Ratio (which is a percentage).
- Scores are computed within 3 seconds of signal ingestion.
- If a signal source is missing, affected scores are marked as 'low confidence' rather than null.
- Feature output is versioned in the system for future model retraining.

Epic 3 Persona Classification

US-09 Primary Persona Assignment [Must Have]	
User Story	As for the system, I want to classify each user into a primary spending persona, so that the recommendation engine has a meaningful behavioural anchor for card ranking.
Acceptance Criteria	
– Every user is assigned exactly one primary persona from the 5 defined personas.	
– Classification uses the rule-based decision tree defined in the PRD.	
– If no single persona scores above threshold, the user is assigned 'Credit Beginner' as a safe default.	
– Classification completes in under 1 second.	
– The person assigned is logged against the session for analytics.	

US-10 Secondary Persona Assignment [Should Have]	
User Story	As the system, I want to assign a secondary persona where applicable, so that blended recommendations can be made for users with mixed spending profiles.
Acceptance Criteria	
– Secondary persona is assigned only when the user's second-highest scoring persona exceeds 60% of the threshold.	
– Secondary persona is used for tie-breaking in card ranking, not primary ordering.	
– Maximum one secondary persona per user.	
– Secondary persona is surfaced to the recommendation engine but not shown to the user in V1.	

Epic 4 Recommendation Engine

US-11 Hard Eligibility Gate [Must Have]	
User Story	As a user, I want to only see cards I am realistically eligible for, so that I do not waste time applying for a card I am unlikely to receive.
Acceptance Criteria	

– Cards where the user's CIBIL score falls below the card's minimum are excluded before scoring.
– Cards where the user's income falls below the card's minimum are excluded before scoring.
– Gate runs before the weighted scoring model excluded cards never enter the ranking.
– If all cards are gated out, only the Credit Builder Card entry card is shown with appropriate messaging.
– Gate logic is driven by the card catalogue configuration, not hardcoded.

US-12 Weighted Recommendation Scoring [Must Have]

User Story

As a user, I want to receive a ranked list of the most suitable cards for me, so that I do not have to evaluate every card myself.

Acceptance Criteria

- Scoring formula applied: Behavioural Fit (40%) + Eligibility Match (30%) + Reward Optimisation (20%) + Conversion Probability (10%).
- All four components are computed for every eligible card.
- Cards are ranked in descending order of final score.
- Top 3 cards are returned to the UI.
- Scoring completes in under 2 seconds.
- If fewer than 3 cards pass the eligibility gate, only passing cards are shown (minimum 1).

US-13 Estimated Annual Benefit Calculation [Should Have]

User Story

As a user, I want to see how much I could earn in rewards per year with each card, so that I can make a financially informed decision.

Acceptance Criteria

- Calculation uses user's average monthly spend per category multiplied by card reward rate multiplied by 12.
- Displayed as 'Estimated Annual Benefit: Rs. X,XXX' on each recommendation card.
- Accompanied by the disclaimer: 'Based on your recent spending patterns.'
- If spend data is insufficient, the field is hidden rather than shown as Rs. 0.

US-14 No-Match Fallback [Must Have]	
User Story	As a user with a thin credit file or very low CIBIL score, I want to still receive a relevant recommendation, so that I am not dead-ended by the flow.
Acceptance Criteria	
– If no standard card passes the eligibility gate, the Credit Builder Card secured card is shown.	
– Messaging reads: 'Start building your credit profile this card is designed for you.'	
– Match score and approval probability are not shown for the fallback card.	
– User is shown a brief explanation of what a secured card is (2 sentences maximum).	
– CTA reads 'Apply Now', consistent with standard cards.	

Epic 5 Explainability

US-15 Recommendation Explanation [Must Have]	
User Story	As a user, I want to understand why a specific card was recommended to me, so that I trust the recommendation and feel confident applying.
Acceptance Criteria	
– Every recommended card shows exactly 3 reasons.	
– Reasons are dynamically generated from the user's actual signals, not static copy.	
– Each reason is one sentence in plain English, under 20 words.	
– Reasons reference specific user data points (e.g., '38% of your spending is online shopping').	
– No jargon terms like 'behavioural fit score' are never shown to the user.	
– Explanations are visible by default, not hidden behind a toggle.	

US-16 Eligibility Confidence Badge [Must Have]	
User Story	As a user, I want to see how likely I am to be approved for each card, so that I can prioritize which card to apply for.

Acceptance Criteria	
–	Every recommended card shows one of three badges: 'You likely qualify', 'You may qualify', or 'Approval not guaranteed'.
–	Badge logic follows the thresholds defined in the PRD (CIBIL gap, income coverage, utilisation).
–	If bureau data is unavailable, the badge is hidden entirely not shown as unknown.
–	Badge is visible on both the results page and the comparison view.
–	Tapping the badge shows a one-line tooltip explaining what it means.

Epic 6 Results & Comparison

US-17 Recommendation Results Page [Must Have]	
User Story	As a user, I want to see my personalised card recommendations on a single page, so that I can quickly evaluate my best options.
Acceptance Criteria	
–	The top card is displayed as 'Best Match' with visual emphasis.
–	Cards 2 and 3 are shown below as 'Also Recommended'.
–	Each card shows: card name, headline benefit, match score, estimated annual benefit, approval badge, and top 3 explanation reasons.
–	Primary CTA 'Apply Now' is present on each card.
–	Page loads within 2 seconds of recommendation engine response.
–	User can scroll to see all 3 cards without leaving the results screen.

US-18 Card Comparison View [Should Have]	
User Story	As a user, I want to compare my top 3 recommended cards side by side, so that I can make a more considered choice between similar options.
Acceptance Criteria	
–	Comparison view is accessible via a 'Compare Cards' CTA on the results page.
–	Side-by-side layout across 5 axes: Annual fee, Reward rate, Key benefits, Approval likelihood, Estimated annual savings.
–	Tapping any card in the comparison view goes directly to that card's apply flow.

– Comparison view works for 2 cards if only 2 are recommended.
– Back navigation returns the user to the results page without re-running the recommendation.

Epic 7 Application Handoff

US-19 Pre-Filled Application [Must Have]	
User Story	As a user, I want my application form to be pre-filled with the details I already provided, so that I do not have to type the same information twice.
Acceptance Criteria	
– PAN, name (from PAN verification), and mobile number are pre-filled.	
– User only needs to complete: address, employment type, employer name, and income declaration.	
– Pre-filled fields are editable in case of corrections.	
– Application state is preserved if the user navigates away and returns within the same session.	
– Form submission goes to the Issuing Bank API no re-entry of data on their end.	

US-20 Application API Handoff [Must Have]	
User Story	As a user, I want my application to be submitted directly to Issuing Bank, so that I do not have to start over on another website.
Acceptance Criteria	
– Application submitted via Issuing Bank API within 3 seconds of user tapping 'Submit'.	
– Success state shows: 'Application submitted! Reference number: XXXXXX'.	
– On API failure, application state is saved locally and user is offered: Retry or Continue on Issuing Bank website via deep link.	
– Deep link pre-populates as much data as possible on the Issuing Bank site.	
– Application reference number is sent to the user's registered mobile via SMS.	

US-21 Application Status Tracking [Should Have]	
User Story	As a user, I want to see my application status after submission, so that I know what happens next without having to contact the bank.
Acceptance Criteria	
– Status screen shown immediately after submission: 'Under Review'.	
– Status updates pulled from Issuing Bank API every 24 hours, or via webhook if available.	
– The user receives a push notification when status changes.	
– Possible statuses: Under Review, Approved, Additional Documents Required, Rejected.	
– On rejection, user is shown the next-best recommended card as an alternative.	

Epic 8 Preference Collection (Consent Fallback)

US-22 Explicit Preference Collection [Must Have]	
User Story	As a user who has not given SMS or bureau consent, I want to answer a few simple questions about my spending, so that I can still receive a useful recommendation.
Acceptance Criteria	
– Maximum 5 questions shown.	
– Questions cover: primary reward preference, monthly income range, top 2 spending categories, employment type, and existing credit cards held.	
– Each question is single-screen with tap-to-select options with no free text entry.	
– The entire flow is complete in under 60 seconds.	
– Responses feed directly into the recommendation engine as a substitute for inferred signals.	
– Users are informed that recommendations based on stated preferences may be less precise than those based on SMS data.	
– Screen 1 'What matters most to you?': Cashback / Travel / Fuel Savings / Rewards Points.	
– Screen 2 'What is your monthly income?': Under Rs. 25K / Rs. 25K–50K / Rs. 50K–1L / Over Rs. 1L.	

– Screen 3 'Where do you spend the most?': Online Shopping / Dining / Fuel / Travel / Groceries.
– Screen 4 'What is your employment type?': Salaried / Self-Employed / Student / Other.
– Screen 5 'Do you have any existing credit cards?': None / 1–2 Cards / 3 or More.

4. MVP Definition

The MVP ships with all 15 Must Have stories complete. At MVP, the product is functional end-to-end: a user can onboard, consent, receive an AI-driven recommendation with explanation and eligibility indicator, and submit an application including fallback paths for denied consent and thin credit files.

Should Have Stories (US-10, US-13, US-18, US-21) ship in the first post-MVP iteration, targeted 3–4 weeks after MVP launch. The Could Have story (US-05 bank statement upload) goes into the backlog for the next planning cycle.

Won't Have items for V1 include: a conversational AI interface, Account Aggregator real-time sync, ML-based persona clustering, cross-sell into loans or insurance, and any card issuers outside Issuing Bank or Platform.

5. MoSCoW Summary

Priority	Count	User Stories
Must Have (M)	15	US-01, US-02, US-03, US-04, US-06, US-07, US-08, US-09, US-11, US-12, US-14, US-15, US-16, US-17, US-19, US-20, US-22
Should Have (S)	4	US-10, US-13, US-18, US-21
Could Have (C)	1	US-05

Won't Have V1 (W)		Conversational AI interface, Account Aggregator integration, cross-sell, portfolio optimisation, ML persona clustering
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